



MOAR!

DEVELOPERS

pncle, Luca Galante

PLATFORMS

Android, macOS,
Linux, Microsoft
Windows, Macintosh
operating systems

PUBLISHERS

Luca Galante, Games
Delta, pncle

PRICE

₹125
(Steam, Early Access)

which get stronger as you level them up. In addition to weapons, you also have straightforward passive buffs, like spinach for instance, which increases the damage you deal by a set percentage, and attractorb, which increases the range at which you can pick objects up. You can have a total of 12 items every run, which include 6 weapons and 6 passive items.

Pickups and leveling up

Speaking of the “objects” you can pick up; the majority of what you’ll be picking up will be xp gems. This is what you need in order to not only level your weapons up, but also get a chance to acquire new weapons and passives. In addition to xp gems, every map in the game has destroyable torches (or some kind of light source), which drops items on destruction. These items can be anything, from the currency you’ll need to purchase power ups, to “floor chicken” which heals your character, to other useful items (like being able to temporarily freeze all enemies on the map).

Once you get your hands on a weapon, you can start leveling it up. Each weapon, with two exceptions for now, can be leveled up a maximum of eight times. At level 8, they’re at their most powerful version. Or are they? Turns out, you can make them EVEN MOAR

powerful. Certain weapons can “evolve” if you have the right corresponding passive item. If everything aligns, i.e., you’ve got the right weapon and your weapon is level 8, then the next boss chest you open should evolve your weapon. These evolved weapons are leagues ahead of their pre-evolution versions,

and once you get your hands on one, the game goes from you running away from enemies, to watching them run towards their doom.

Power ups

The game starts off pretty hard; it can be difficult to cross even the 10 minute mark on your first run, however, the game gets easier with each run. This is due to several reasons. For one, you’re actually getting better at the game. Second, you earn currency each run, this currency can then be used in the powerup shop to give yourself a permanent stat boost. These include things like increased damage, armor, projectiles, area and more. It will take a good while before you’re able to unlock every single thing in the powerup store, but when you do, the difference between when you first started playing and with all power ups unlocked is significant. There are also certain weapons and pickups that are unlocked only by play-

ing the game; you don’t get access to them unless you successfully accomplish a specific objective. For instance, the powerful duplicator passive item which increases all of your projectiles by 1, can only be acquired if you get the magic wand weapon we mentioned above to level 7. Once you accomplish that, the duplicator is permanently added to the pool of passive items you might acquire while leveling up. It’s also added to the powerup store, as a permanent boost you can purchase for what might be a pretty hefty (but worth) price for new players. This applies to every passive item you can unlock, which shows up in the power up store as you unlock them.

The Characters

Finally, we come to the characters themselves. There are 23 characters in the game as of writing this review, including 4 secret characters. Each character has unique passive abilities, like Antonio (whip guy) gains 10% more damage every 10 levels. Some characters have powerful passives, and some have situational passive abilities that work really well with specific builds.

Graphics and audio

You would be forgiven for thinking that this game was from the 90s. You might even think the sprites are pulled directly from the first Castlevania game. Much like the gameplay, the graphics are also as simple as it gets. There’s very little animation save for the weapons themselves which can look very flashy. But we didn’t really think this was an issue; keeping things simple is good, especially with the amount of chaos on the screen, there’s little time to appreciate minor details if there are any.

Verdict

Vampire Survivors is a prime example of the adage ‘simple is better’. I haven’t met a single person who said they didn’t get their money’s worth and then some playing VS. The fact that it costs only ₹125, and it’s still in Early Access. Don’t take my word for it, just try out the free demo on itch.io and let me know if you got as hooked as we did. *